

President attacks mail-in ballots, machines

Trump says Putin told him that voting via postal service led to his 2020 defeat.

By MICHAEL WILNER

President Trump said Monday he would renew his assault on mail-in voting after Russia’s autocratic leader, Vladimir Putin, told him to do so at their meeting in Alaska last week.

The president provided few details but wrote on social media that he would “lead a movement to get rid of MAIL-IN BALLOTS, and also, while we’re at it, Highly ‘Inaccurate,’ Very Expensive, and Seriously Controversial VOTING MACHINES.”

Already in March, Trump had issued an executive order directing the Justice Department to “take all necessary action” to prevent mail-in ballots received after election day from being counted. The order also attempted to impose a proof of citizenship requirement for voter registration.

Those portions of the executive action have been enjoined by courts over constitutional concerns.

But another provision, directing the independent U.S. Election Assistance Commission to shift its guidance on voting machines banning the use of certain bar codes and quick-response codes, has been allowed to proceed.

The U.S. Constitution states that the timing, place and manner of elections “shall be prescribed in each state” by local legislatures, and that Congress has the ability to pass laws altering state election regulations. The president is given no authority to prescribe or govern election procedures.

Nevertheless, Trump wrote Monday that states “are merely an ‘agent’ for the Federal Government in counting and tabulating the votes.”

“They must do what the Federal Government, as represented by the President of the United States, tells them, FOR THE GOOD OF OUR COUNTRY, to do,” he wrote.

Oregon Secretary of State Tobias Read said in a statement that Trump is “actively working to corrupt our elections.”

“If he actually understood or cared about the American people, he’d know mail-in-voting is the best way to protect everyone’s right to vote, especially rural [See Voting, A8]



PRESIDENT TRUMP with the leaders of, from left, Finland, Ukraine, France, Italy, Germany and NATO.

WIN McNAMEE/Getty Images

Jewish faculty unite in defense of UCLA

By DANIEL MILLER AND JAWEED KALEEM

A large swath of UCLA’s Jewish faculty — some of whom are fervently divided over Israel’s war in Gaza — united to sign a letter denouncing the Trump administration’s “misguided and punitive” demand for a \$1-billion fine to settle claims over alleged campus antisemitism.

The letter, crafted by a handful of professors and signed by more than 360 people, was expected to be sent by organizers as early as Monday afternoon to the University of California’s Board of Regents. It also decries the government’s freezing of \$584 million in research grant funding.

“Cutting off hundreds of millions of research funds will do nothing to make UCLA safer for Jews nor diminish antisemitism in the world,” the letter said. “It will not benefit Jewish Bruins nor Jews beyond campus who make extensive use of its first-rate medical facilities, ground-breaking scientific innovations.” [See UCLA, A14]



GENARO MOLINA/Los Angeles Times

A LETTER signed by over 360 members of UCLA’s Jewish community criticizes President Trump’s “misplaced efforts” to punish the school.

Extreme heat wave is set to hit Southland

By GRACE TOOHEY

The season’s most dangerous heat wave is expected to bake Southern California and much of the American Southwest this week, with triple-digit highs and elevated fire conditions set to begin Wednesday and last for several days.

Extreme heat and fire weather advisories have been issued for much of inland Southern California, with peak temperatures expected Thursday and Friday. Downtown Los Angeles is forecast to reach 94 degrees, while Woodland Hills

could hit 108. Los Angeles County valleys and the Inland Empire probably will heat up to 104 degrees. Palm Springs could hit above 113 and Death Valley is bracing for 120 degrees, according to the National Weather Service.

“This is going to be the most significant heat wave of the season so far,” said Ariel Cohen, the meteorologist in charge at the weather service’s Oxnard office. “We’re going to be having a once-a-year, once-every-other-year-caliber heat wave. ... Everyone needs to be getting prepared now.”

Although this is typically

the hottest time of year, he said, highs at the end of the week will reach near records, 10 to 20 degrees above normal. People need to stay hydrated, make sure they have access to air conditioning and refrain from outside activities in the heat of the day in order to avoid heat-related illness, Cohen said.

“The most impactful heat and fire weather concerns will pick up Wednesday through Sunday,” the weather service warned in a statement. “Consider reassessing outdoor plans for that time, stay hydrated, and be careful with anything that can spark a fire.”

The high-pressure system driving this heat wave will not only persist over the region for a prolonged period, but is also expected to be “stronger than normal,” said Kristan Lund, another weather service meteorologist in Oxnard.

“This high pressure is sitting out over us for a long duration,” Lund said. “We could see temperatures still elevated for this time of year ... into early next week.”

The system’s length and strength will be compounded by some offshore winds, which will help keep any marine influence at bay [See Heat, A14]

TRUMP WANTS PUTIN, ZELENSKY TO MEET

Trilateral talks with U.S. would follow, he says. Moscow offers an evasive response.

By MICHAEL WILNER

The presidents of Russia and Ukraine may finally meet to discuss peace after 3½ years of war, President Trump said Monday, hosting European leaders at the White House in a push to resolve the conflict.

But it is unclear whether the Kremlin has agreed to the proposal, telling reporters only that Russian President Vladimir Putin would consider “raising the level” of negotiations between Russia’s and Ukraine’s representatives.

Trump proposed that Putin and Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky meet one on one “at a location to be determined,” taking a call with the Russian leader in the middle of a high-stakes meeting with Zelensky and his European counterparts.

“After that meeting takes place, we will have a Trilat, which would be the two Presidents, plus myself,” Trump wrote on social media. “Again, this was a very good, early step for a War that has been going on for almost four years.”

The president’s statement came after European leaders urged Trump to “put pressure” on Russia, after his meeting with Putin in Alaska last week sparked widespread fears over the fate of U.S. support for security on the continent.

The meeting had a historic flavor, with six European [See Ukraine, A6]

Dealer to plead guilty in Perry overdose

By RICHARD WINTON

A drug dealer dubbed the “Ketamine Queen” has agreed to plead guilty to five federal criminal charges, including that she provided the drug that ultimately led actor Matthew Perry to suffer a fatal overdose in October 2023, prosecutors announced Monday.

Jasveen Sangha, 42, also admitted in her plea agreement to selling four vials of ketamine to Cody McLaury in August 2019. McLaury, 33, died hours later in his Los Angeles home from a drug overdose that included ketamine.

Sangha agreed to plead guilty to one count of maintaining a drug-involved premises, three counts of distribution of ketamine, and one count of distribution of ketamine resulting in death or serious bodily injury.

She was one of five people charged with conspiracy to distribute ketamine to Perry, who died from acute effects of the drug. Sangha supplied the ketamine the “Friends” actor injected on the day of his death, according to the plea agreement, which also noted that she sold drugs for years out of her North Hollywood apartment, described in a federal indictment as the “Sangha stash house.”

As part of a deal struck [See Perry, A6]

California cap-and-trade at crossroads; billions at stake

By HAYLEY SMITH

As California pushes toward its ambitious goals for addressing climate change, the fate of its signature program is hanging in the balance.

For months, lawmakers, industry groups and environmental advocates have been mired in negotiations over whether and how to extend the cap-and-trade program, which limits planet-warming emissions, beyond its 2030 expiration date. Without a reauthorization well in advance, companies are less likely to make the expensive investments necessary to reduce their effluent.

The cap-and-trade program was nation-leading when it was authorized by state law in 2006. It requires major polluters such as power plants, oil refineries

Struggling to hit targets

California is not on track to meet these future greenhouse gas reduction goals

40% by 2030
85% by 2045

Current annual rate of gas reductions
~2.5%

and other industrial facilities to purchase allowances, or credits, for each ton of carbon dioxide they emit, and lets those companies buy or sell their unused allowances at quarterly auctions. Each year fewer credits are created, lowering the total annual climate pollution in the state.

Gov. Gavin Newsom is advocating for the program to be extended to 2045, and hopes to see it reauthorized before the end of the legislative session on Sept. 12. Cap-and-trade currently covers about two-thirds of California’s greenhouse gas emissions, and its auctions generate billions of dollars for the state each year.

Most experts agree the program must continue in order for California to reach its goal of carbon neutrality by 2045. But while Newsom is pushing for it to be reauthorized largely in its current form, critics say considerable reforms are needed to address concerns about how cap-and-trade is run and where the money is spent.

The California Air Resources Board, which administers the program, is in [See Climate, A11]

MYUNG J. CHUN/Los Angeles Times

L.A.’S TOLL ON MONO LAKE

Efforts have failed to restore the oasis for migratory birds to a healthy water level. A new campaign to save it is afoot. CALIFORNIA, B1

Texas Democrats end walkout

Their return will allow GOP to redraw voting maps as California advances an opposing effort. NATION, A8

Weather Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 86/67. B6

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Rams’ Stafford finally back at it

Veteran quarterback takes snaps in camp for first time since his back problem. SPORTS, B10

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